

Tuesday, 15 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

22° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

20° 14°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

19° 14°

GLASGOW

Rain

18° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Prime Minister Andy Burnham has cancelled all engagements after the sad news that his father has passed away.

Mr Burnham has spoken openly in the past about his father's battle with Alzheimer's disease, and how he wasn't aware his son had become Prime Minister. Our thoughts are with him and his family.

POLITICS · UK

2

A member of the UK armed forces has tragically died in a road traffic incident in Ukraine.

It's understood the incident was not the result of any hostile action. No further details have been released at this time.

DEFENCE · UK

3

The 'Speedboat Killer' Jack Shepherd has been jailed again, this time for attacking his girlfriend.

Shepherd was sentenced at Isleworth Crown Court after admitting the violent assault. He was previously jailed for the manslaughter of Charlotte Brown on a first date.

CRIME · UK

4

MPs and Lords are calling for a brand new law to address the growing threat AI poses to human rights.

They argue that our existing laws simply aren't equipped to deal with the rapid advancements and risks of artificial intelligence. It's a really important debate we need to have.

TECHNOLOGY · UK

5

Gloomy news for tenants, as rent rises are expected to speed up significantly in the coming months.

Property website Zoopla forecasts that the cost of renting could increase by 4% or 5% a year by December. It's tough news for many households.

ECONOMY · UK

What's coming up

1

Good news for Oasis fans! The band have confirmed more huge reunion gigs, including a return to Knebworth.

After weeks of teasing, Liam and Noel have announced a second wave of shows for their hit reunion tour. They'll also be playing in Manchester and Glasgow in 2027.

ON AIR – Are you excited about more Oasis dates? Which city are you hoping to get tickets for?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2

Céline Dion has made a hugely emotional and celebrated comeback, kicking off her tour in Paris.

The iconic Canadian singer performed her first show after a six-year hiatus due to health issues. Critics are calling it a 'high-stakes' and triumphant return.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Céline Dion song? Are you glad to see her back on stage?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

3

The stars of the 'Practical Magic' reboot say people are longing for simpler times.

Actresses Maisie Williams and Joey King feature in the upcoming sequel to the much-loved 1998 fantasy romcom. It's due out soon.

ON AIR – Do you agree that we're all looking for a bit more simplicity these days? Are you a fan of the original 'Practical Magic'?

FILM · COMING UP

4

A brand new romantic comedy is setting its sights on the East End of Glasgow, rather than Notting Hill!

The film, called 'Premature', is out in cinemas next Friday, despite being made on a microscopic budget. It's great to see new talent coming through.

ON AIR – What's your favourite romcom setting? Could Glasgow be the new Hollywood?

FILM · COMING UP

5

Harry Potter star Tom Felton says he's 'so excited' to see Rupert Grint play Ron Weasley again.

Tom, who played Draco Malfoy, is currently taking on Broadway and spoke about his friendship with his former co-stars. It's all about the upcoming TV series.

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to seeing the original cast members return for the new Harry Potter series? Who are you most excited for?

TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 Alexander Zverev has claimed his second Grand Slam title, winning the US Open after beating Ben Shelton.**
Zverev won the final in four sets, 6-3, 6-6 (7-6), 5-7, 6-2. It's a huge moment for the German tennis star.

ON AIR – Did you follow the US Open final? Who were you backing to win?

TENNIS · THIS WEEK
- 2 Erling Haaland scored a controversial winner as Manchester City beat rivals Manchester United in the derby.**
City won despite playing with 10 men for over 70 minutes, after Phil Foden was sent off. The Premier League refereeing body has since admitted an error in awarding Haaland's goal.

ON AIR – What did you make of the Manchester derby? Was it a fair result, or was VAR wrong?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 Europe has regained the Solheim Cup, with captain Anna Nordqvist's faith in young rookies paying off.**
The team delivered crucial points in their victory over the United States. It was a fantastic display of golf.

ON AIR – Did you watch the Solheim Cup? What was your highlight from the tournament?

GOLF · THIS WEEK
- 4 The new Madrid F1 circuit is set for changes after receiving criticism following its inaugural race at the weekend.**
Spanish Grand Prix organisers are looking to make adjustments to the track. It's always a challenge with new circuits to get them just right.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the new F1 circuits, or do you prefer the classic tracks? What makes a good F1 circuit?

FORMULA 1 · THIS WEEK
- 5 The County Championship title race is going right down to the wire, with three teams still in the hunt.**
Somerset, Nottinghamshire and Warwickshire are separated by just five points with only two matches left to play. It's set to be a thrilling finish to the season!

ON AIR – Who are you backing to win the County Championship? What's been your highlight of the cricket season so far?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals that the sound of distant church bells is one of Britain's most cherished calming sounds.**
Researchers found that the gentle chime often evokes a sense of peace and nostalgia for many, linking it to quiet village life and Sunday mornings.
- 2 The delightful hobby of 'creating miniature gardens' in unusual containers is blossoming across the UK.**
From old teacups to broken terracotta pots, people are finding joy in crafting tiny landscapes, often complete with tiny fences and benches.
- 3 Apparently, a 'perfectly ironed pillowcase' is now considered a small luxury that significantly improves sleep quality for some.**
The crispness and smooth feel are said to contribute to a feeling of calm and comfort, making bedtime extra appealing.
- 4 The charm of 'collecting interesting pebbles and stones' from walks is making a quiet comeback.**
People are showcasing their natural treasures in bowls and on shelves, each stone a unique memory of an outdoor adventure.
- 5 A quirky trend sees more Britons embracing the art of 'designing and sending their own postcards' from home.**
Instead of buying pre-made ones, people are getting creative, personalising their greetings with drawings, photos, and even collages for friends and family.
- 6 It turns out that the 'gentle whirring of an old fan' is a surprisingly popular background noise for concentration and relaxation.**
For many, it's a comforting, rhythmic sound that helps block out distractions and can even aid in falling asleep.
- 7 The simple pleasure of 'arranging freshly cut flowers' in an unexpected place is bringing daily cheer to many households.**
From a tiny bud in a jam jar on a bedside table to a vibrant bunch brightening a hallway, these small acts are boosting spirits.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: LOOKING AT THE PICTURE ON THE BOX AND DECIDING IF THE MILK SPLASH LOOKS 'JUST RIGHT'.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot drink, especially if it's a new blend. What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE MUG A LITTLE 'TAP-TAP' ON THE TABLE, JUST TO MAKE SURE IT FEELS STURDY.

TALK TOPIC

- We all have that 'one particular shop' we absolutely adore, no matter how small or niche, that just makes our day better when we visit, don't we?

What's that special shop for you? Is it a local bakery, an old bookshop, or perhaps a quirky antique store, and what makes it so charming?

- You know how sometimes a 'particular piece of everyday advice' from an older relative or friend just sticks with you and proves to be surprisingly useful?

What's the best bit of simple, practical advice you've ever received that you still use regularly today?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Before pencils and erasers were common, people in the 18th century used rolled-up breadcrumbs to rub out mistakes from their writing.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first public clock in London, installed in the 14th century, only had an hour hand and rang a bell every seven and a half minutes.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The world's smallest commercially available car is the Peel P50, a three-wheeled microcar made in the Isle of Man.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar sources.
- The 'king' in a deck of playing cards is the only one without a moustache.
- The inventor of the Pringle, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one of the iconic Pringle cans.
- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds, as they are made up of millions of tiny water droplets.
- The sound of Big Ben's chimes is E major.

On this day

Day 258 of the year, 107 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Britain Day (United Kingdom); Christian feast day: Joseph Abibos; Christian feast day: Alpinus (Albinus) of Lyon; Christian feast day: Aprus (Évre) of Toul. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Tommy Lee Jones, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1971 — Josh Charles, American actor and director
- 1981 — Ben Schwartz, American actor, comedian and writer
- 1964 — Steve Watkin, Welsh cricketer
- 1979 — Amy Davidson, American actress
- 1922 — Bob Anderson, English fencer and choreographer (died 2012)
- 1952 — Kelly Keagy, American singer and drummer
- 1977 — Sophie Dahl, English model and author

THE DAY TODAY

- 1968 — The Soviet Zond 5 spaceship is launched, becoming the first spacecraft to fly around the Moon and re-enter the Earth's atmosphere.
- 2001 — During a CART race at the Lausitzring in Germany, former Formula One driver Alex Zanardi suffers a heavy accident resulting in him losing both his legs.
- 1971 — The first Greenpeace ship departs from Vancouver to protest against the upcoming Cannikin nuclear weapon test in Alaska.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The United Nations cedes Eritrea to Ethiopia.
- 1974 — Air Vietnam Flight 706 is hijacked, then crashes while attempting to land with 75 on board.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1968 — The Soviet Zond 5 spaceship is launched, becoming the first spacecraft to fly around the Moon and re-enter the Earth's atmosphere.
- 2020 — Signing of the Bahrain–Israel normalization agreement occurs in Washington, D.C., normalizing relations between Israel and two Arab nations, the United Arab Emirates and Bahrain.

- 1971 — The first Greenpeace ship departs from Vancouver to protest against the upcoming Cannikin nuclear weapon test in Alaska.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 259 of the year, 106 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Curcodomus; Christian feast day: Cyprian (Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Edith of Wilton; Christian feast day: Euphemia. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Sabrina Bryan, American singer-songwriter, dancer, and actress
- 1988 — Teddy Geiger, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actress
- 1986 — Kyla Pratt, American actress and singer
- 1977 — Musiq Soulchild, American singer-songwriter
- 1969 — Justine Frischmann, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1993 — Sam Byram, English footballer
- 1942 — Bernie Calvert, English bass player and keyboard player
- 1971 — Joel Heyman, American actor, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2015 — A 8.3 Mw earthquake strikes the Chilean city of Illapel, killing 15 people, injuring at least 34, leaving at least six missing, and causing extensive damage. One person also dies in Argentina.
- 1978 — The 7.4 Mw Tabas earthquake affects the city of Tabas, Iran with a maximum Mercalli intensity of IX (Violent). At least 15,000 people are killed.
- 2022 — The death of Mahsa Amini occurred in Tehran, Iran, sparking worldwide protests.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — The first prototype of the Mikoyan MiG-31 interceptor makes its maiden flight.
- 2021 — A 6.0 Mw earthquake strikes Lu County, Sichuan, China, killing three and injuring more than 88.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar